

centralized institutions needed for basic financial actions. In DeFi, you can be your own bank and get credit from code on a blockchain—no institution required!

Yet so little of the infrastructure of this ecosystem has been built. We are perhaps 1 percent, likely less, into DeFi as a phenomenon. A burgeoning ecosystem of developers around the world is currently constructing the financial building blocks of tomorrow. At our crypto investment firm Paradigm, we often ask ourselves, “If there were a periodic table of financial primitives, what has been built today and what is left to fill in?” That is the opportunity for entrepreneurs.

DeFi, like the internet, will likely make financial services cheaper, faster, secure, personalized, and more. If YouTube grew the breadth of video content by orders of magnitude because it was free and easy for anyone to both create and use videos, what will DeFi do for financial products as it similarly allows anyone to create and use anything at near-zero cost?

That future has yet to be written. This book provides a peek into that future, and you, the reader, hold the power to create it.

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